BUSINESS PERFORMANCE ANALYSIS

Superstore Sales & Profitability Analysis

Turning Sales Data into Profitable Growth

ANALYSIS PERIOD: 2023–2026

PREPARED BY: MARCELINE SETIAWAN · DATA ANALYST

Project Overview

This project analyzes Superstore's sales, profit, discount, and return data from 2023 to 2026 using Tableau. The goal is to understand business performance, identify areas of low profitability, and uncover opportunities to improve customer experience and support more profitable growth.



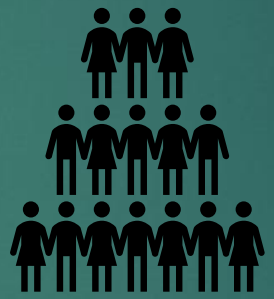
Evaluate Business Performance

Understand sales, profit, and profit margin across regions, product categories, and customer segments.



Identify Profitability Opportunities

Identify high-sales, low-profit products and examine the relationship between discount levels and profitability.



Assess Customer Experience

Examine return-rate patterns and shipping duration to identify areas that may require further investigation.



Recommend Business Actions

Translate analytical findings into practical recommendations to improve profitability, review discount practices, and reduce potentially avoidable returns.

Meeting Agenda

01	**Introduction** Project background and business context	**4 minutes**
02	**Poject Overview and Goals** Scope of analysis and key objectives	**3 minutes**
03	**Business Purpose** The business questions and challenges being addressed	**3 minutes**
04	**Data & Methodology** Dataset, data preparation, and analytical approach	**5 minutes**
05	**Key Findings** Sales performance, profitability, discount impact, and returns	**15 minutes**
06	**Recommendations** Opportunities to improve profitability and customer experience	**5 minutes**
07	**Next Steps & Decisions** Proposed actions, priorities, and alignment on business direction	**5 minutes**

“What Business Problem Are We Solving?”

How can Superstore improve customer experience and identify opportunities to increase profitable sales?

KEY QUESTION :

1. Which regions, categories, and customer segments drive sales and profit?
2. Which products generate high sales but low or negative profit?
3. How is discounting associated with profitability?
4. Which regions and product sub-categories have higher return rates?
5. What actions can improve profitability while reducing potential customer-experience issues?

From Raw Data to Business Insights

01

Data Preparation

Cleaned and prepared the Superstore dataset; created analytical fields and incorporated relevant return and regional information.

02

Data Analysis

Compared sales, profit, margins, products, discount bands, regional performance, and return patterns.

03

Visualization

Used Tableau charts, KPI cards, a map, and interactive dashboards to investigate performance.

04

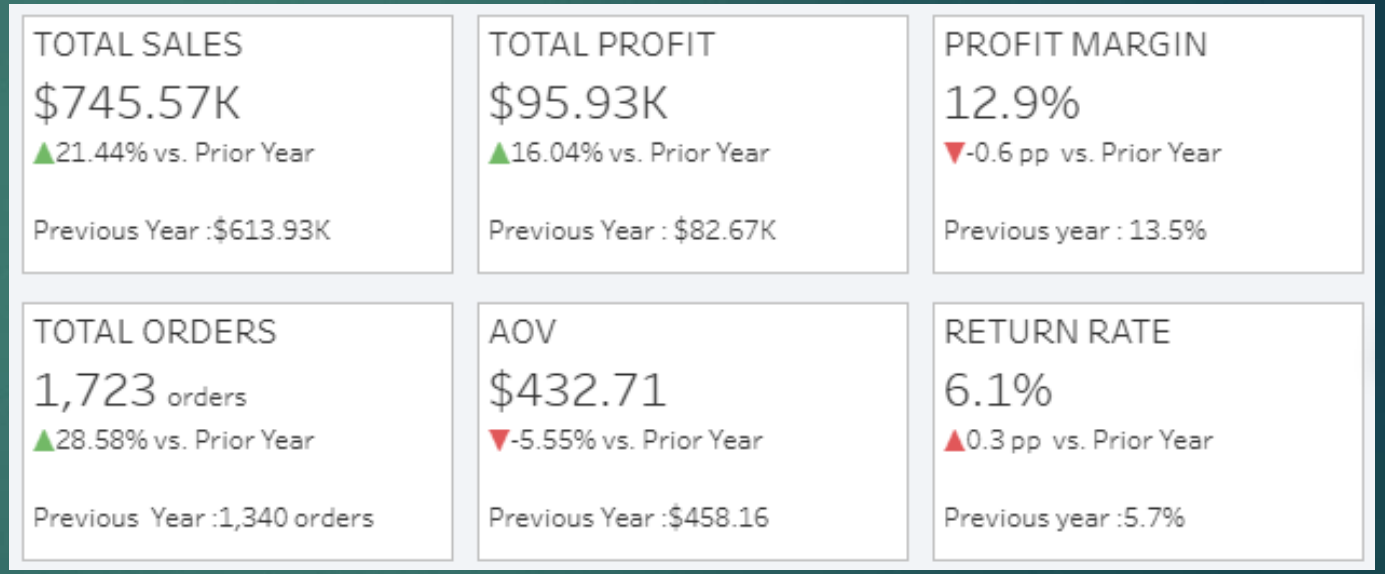
Business Recommendations

Identified opportunities for further investigation and improvement based on the findings.

Data period: 2023–2026 | Tool: Tableau | Analytical methods: Descriptive, comparative, and trend analysis.

Sales Are Growing, but Profitability Needs Attention

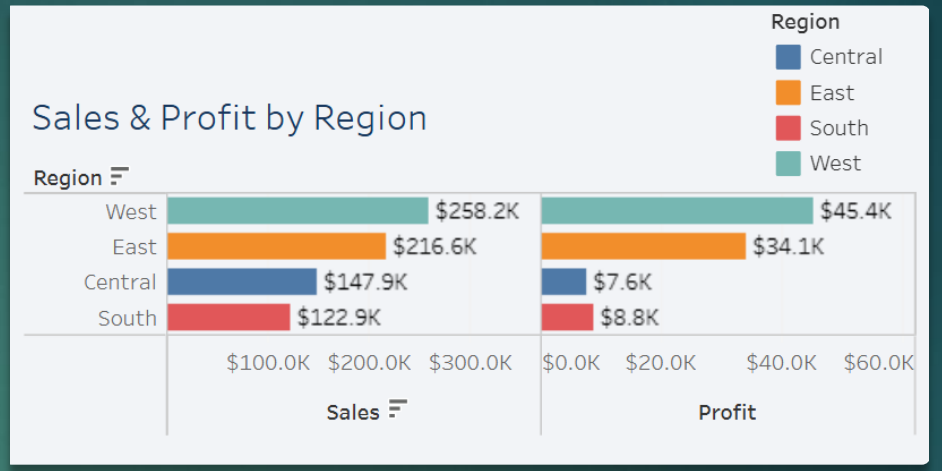
- Sales and profit increased, but sales grew faster than profit.
- Certain products and discount bands showed weak or negative profitability.
- The rising return rate warrants further investigation.

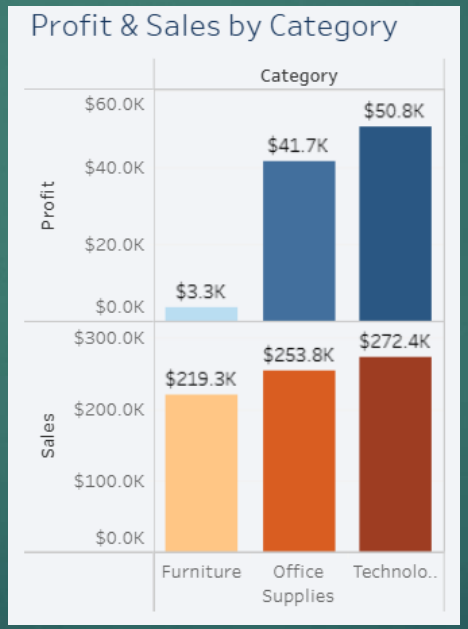


Overall Business Performance (2023–2026)

Performance Varies Across Regions and Categories

- The West recorded the highest regional sales at approximately $258.2K and the highest profit at $45.4K.
- Central recorded approximately $147.9K in sales but only $7.6K in profit.
- Technology led the categories, generating approximately $272.4K in sales and $50.8K in profit.
- Furniture generated approximately $219.3K in sales but only $3.3K in profit.



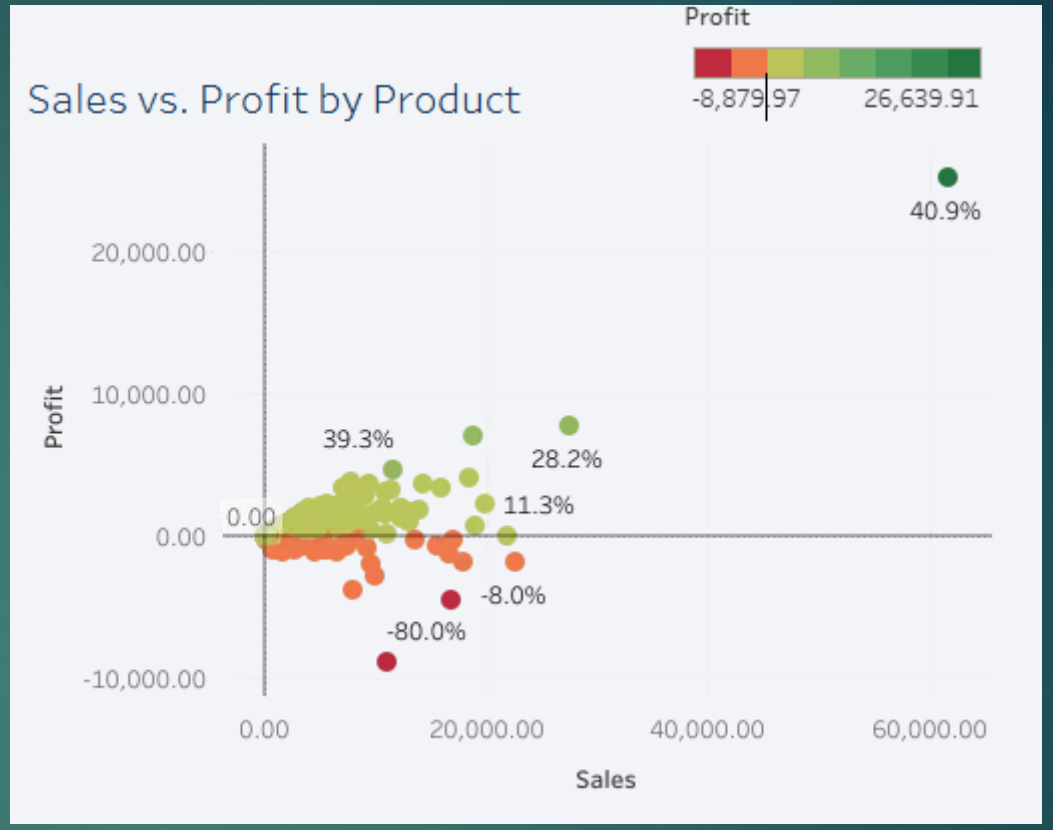


"Revenue alone does not explain business performance. Product mix, discounting, and costs may help explain the differences in profit contribution."

Some Products Generate Sales but Destroy Value

- Some products have high sales but negative profit.
- Tables, Bookcases, and Supplies also showed negative margins in the sub-category analysis.
- Sales rankings alone can conceal loss-making products.

Recommendation:
Review pricing, product costs, discount levels, and sales history for loss-making products before deciding whether to reprice, renegotiate costs, adjust promotions, or discontinue them.

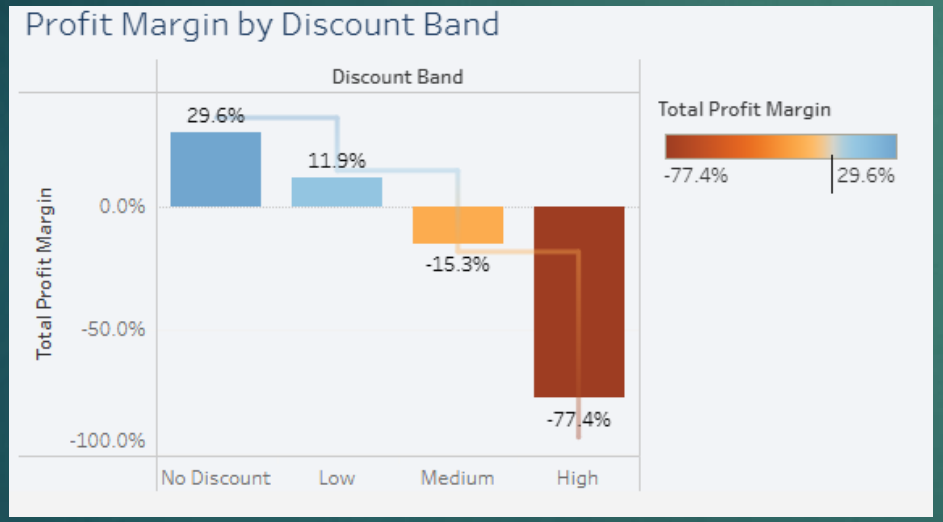


Product Profitability Table

Product Name	Sales	Profit	Total Profit ..	Avg. Discount
Cubify Cubex 3D Printer D..	$11,100.0	-$8,880.0	-80.0%	53.33%
Lexmark Mx611Dhe Mono..	$16,829.9	-$4,590.0	-27.3%	40.00%
Cubify Cubex 3D Printer T..	$8,000.0	-$3,840.0	-48.0%	50.00%
Chromcraft Bull-Nose Wo..	$9,917.6	-$2,876.1	-29.0%	28.00%
Bush Advantage Collectio..	$9,544.7	-$1,934.4	-20.3%	35.00%

Higher Discount Bands Are Associated with Weaker Profitability

Profit margin declines sharply across the higher discount bands, with negative margins in the Medium and High groups.





Recommendation:

Review discount policies and introduce profitability checks before approving promotions.

Rising Returns Need Investigation

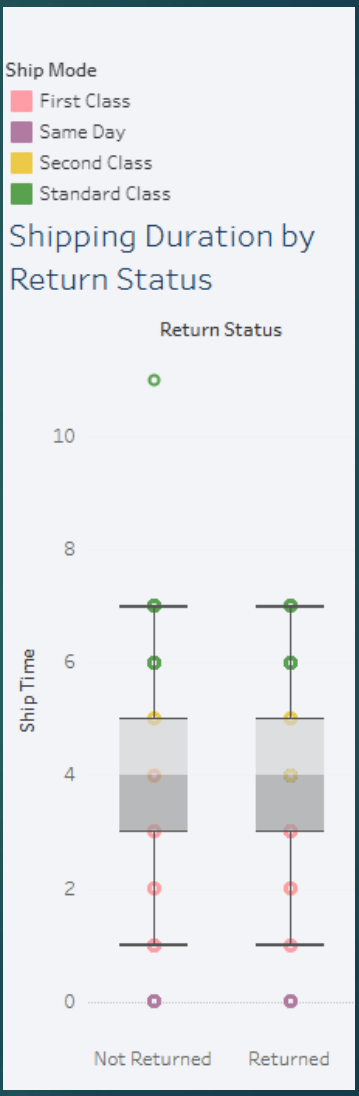
- Return rate increased from **5.7% to 6.1%**.
- Returned orders increased from **77 to 105**.
- Several West-region sub-categories, including Fasteners, Appliances, and Machines, showed elevated displayed return rates.
- Shipping-duration distributions appeared broadly similar for returned and non-returned orders.

Return Rate

0.00% 20.27%

Return Rate Heatmap

Category	Sub-Catego..	Region: Central	East	South	West
Furniture	Bookcases	6.12%	4.29%	0.00%	11.11%
	Chairs	0.68%	5.56%	4.76%	16.58%
	Furnishings	4.15%	3.57%	5.37%	13.80%
	Tables	2.94%	7.41%	8.16%	15.52%
Office Supplies	Appliances	4.20%	3.20%	6.33%	19.12%
	Art	4.85%	3.07%	3.08%	11.59%
	Binders	4.66%	3.97%	4.27%	16.87%
	Envelopes	1.69%	4.11%	3.92%	10.29%
	Fasteners	1.85%	4.35%	0.00%	20.27%
	Labels	6.94%	0.98%	0.00%	12.50%
	Paper	3.55%	5.52%	3.11%	16.58%
	Storage	4.69%	3.03%	2.56%	13.77%
	Supplies	5.71%	5.26%	6.90%	13.24%
Technology	Accessories	5.23%	6.28%	3.36%	11.44%
	Copiers	0.00%	9.09%	0.00%	12.00%
	Machines	5.00%	11.11%	0.00%	19.51%
	Phones	1.63%	7.51%	7.09%	15.27%



Investigate the main reasons for returns, particularly for the affected products and regions. Review product quality, damage, and order accuracy to identify opportunities to reduce returns and improve customer experience.

Four Priorities for Improving Business Performance



Improve product profitability

Investigate loss-making products and weak sub-categories. Review prices, costs, and product performance before deciding on corrective action.



Strengthen discount controls

Introduce margin checks and assess whether promotional discounts generate sufficient profit.



Investigate regional differences

Understand why Central's profit is low relative to sales and identify practices that may be transferable from stronger regions.



Investigate and reduce avoidable returns

Validate return metrics, identify return reasons, and monitor improvements by product group and region.

From Findings to Action



Validate the priority issues

Confirm the product profitability and return-rate findings, and identify the highest-impact cases to investigate.



Assign business owners

Involve the relevant pricing, sales, procurement, and customer service teams to investigate root causes.



Test improvement measures

Evaluate selected pricing or discount changes and investigate preventable return reasons before applying wider changes.



Monitor the results

Track profit margin, sales, discount performance, and return rate to determine whether the actions improve results.

Management Decisions Needed

Agree on priorities, responsible owners, potential pilot actions, and performance review measures.

Key Takeaway

The opportunity is not simply to sell more, but to understand which sales create value, protect profitability, and improve the customer experience.

Thank you · Questions & Discussion